MarkingForge

Preset packs - ready-made dials for modelling, animation, look-dev and archviz

3DS MAX 2027 · VERSION 1.5.54

Four sets of dials for one kind of work each. A pack replaces only the dials it names and leaves the rest of your layout as it is. Load one, try it for a day, keep what works - or take a single dial of a pack from the dial library.

Contents

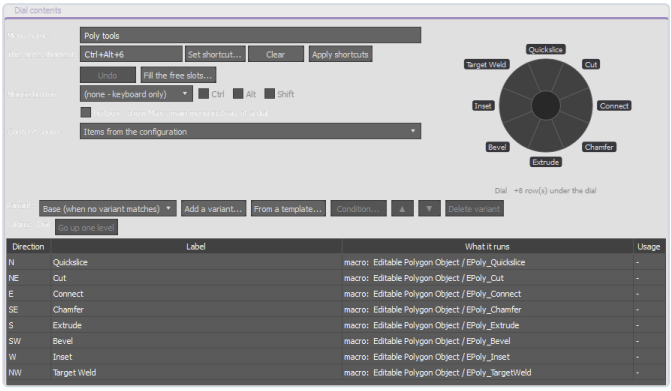
1. Loading a pack
2. Modelling pack
3. Animation pack
4. LookDev pack
5. Archviz pack
6. Make your own pack
7. Support, bug reports and feature requests

Loading a pack

1. Open **MarkingForge > Menu editor...**
2. Press **Load preset...** at the bottom and open a file from the `Presets` folder of the download.
3. The editor lists the dials the pack replaces - read it and press **Load (without scripts)**; the packs have none.
4. Look at the dials in the editor, then press **Save**. The dials change at once - no restart.



Before loading: the dials the Modelling pack will replace.



After loading: dial 14 is now Poly tools.

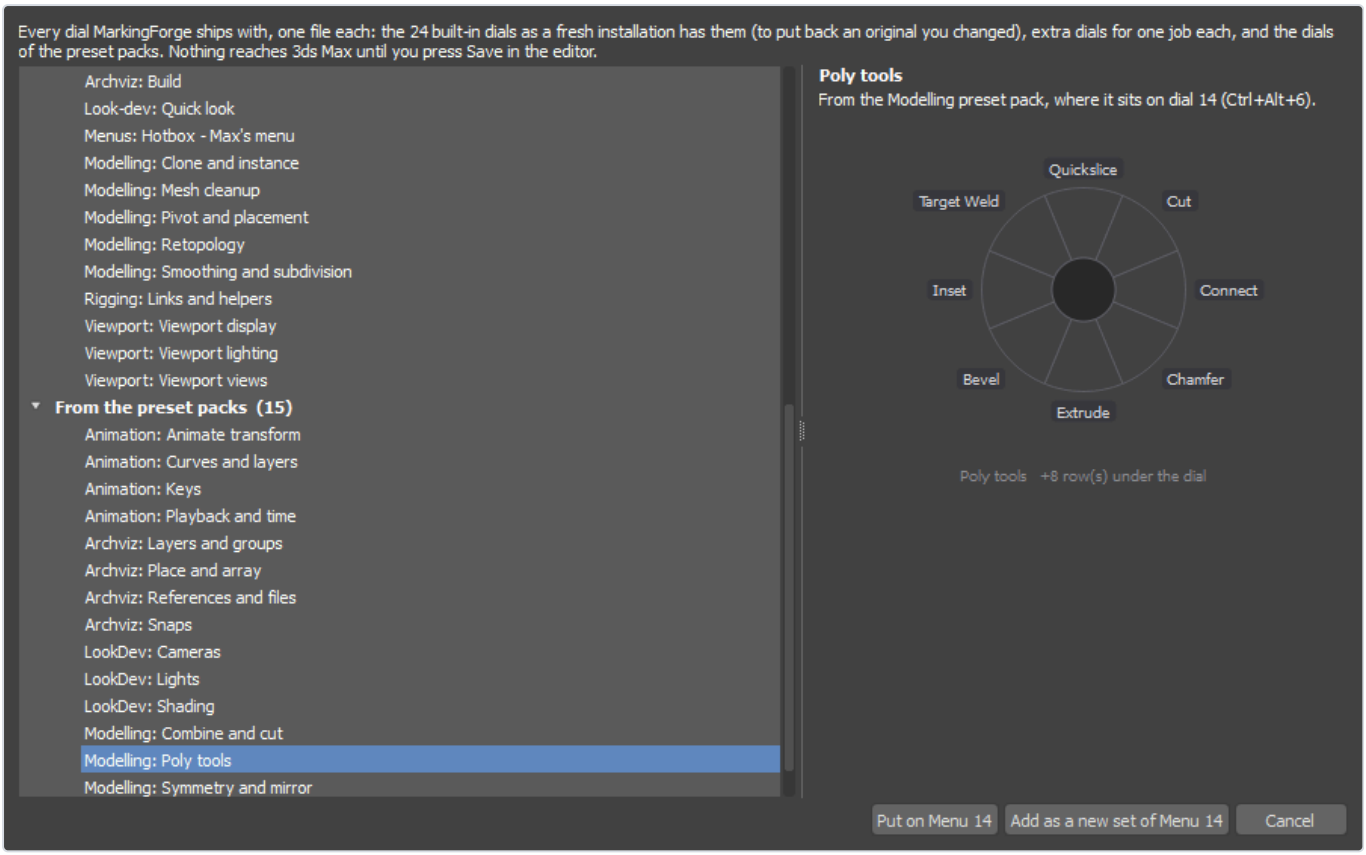
> **Want your dials back?** Before saving: **Reload from file** throws the pack away. After saving, one dial at a time: **Dial library...** > *Built-in dials, as shipped* > the dial (say *Menu 14 - Show and hide*) > **Put on Menu 14**. All of them: **Load default dials...** (tick *Replace the slots that already have a menu as well*) restores the whole built-in layout. Or keep a copy of your own before trying a pack: **Save every dial...** (every dial with its sets and colours - **Load every dial...** puts it back) or **Save preset...**.

> The packs contain only 3ds Max commands - no scripts - so nothing is removed when they load, and every command was checked against a stock release of 3ds Max 2027.

One dial of a pack - the dial library

Every dial of the four packs is also a file of its own, in the editor's dial library and in `Dials\Packs` of the download. Take only the one you want, on any key:

1. Select the dial in the editor's list of dials and press **Dial library...** (or right-click the dial > **Put a dial from the library on Menu N...**).
2. Open *From the preset packs* and pick a dial - *Modelling: Poly tools*, say. Its drawing shows on the right.
3. **Put on Menu N** replaces what the dial shows (its key and mouse button stay). **Add as a new set of Menu N** keeps it: the key still opens what it opened, and the pack's dial is the next page - hold the key and turn the mouse wheel.
4. **Save**.



The dial library: one dial of the Modelling pack, ready to go on Menu 14 or to be added as a new set of it.

The packs at a glance

Pack	For	Replaces
Modelling `MarkingForge_Pack_Modelling.json`	Hard-surface and poly modelling: the poly tools on one key whatever the sub-object level, symmetry and mirror tools, combining and cutting, and a viewport check dial.	Poly tools (Ctrl+Alt+6, was: Show and hide), Symmetry and mirror (Ctrl+Alt+8, was: Viewports), Combine and cut (Shift+Alt+1, was: Viewport display), Viewport check (Shift+Alt+4, was: Render)
Animation `MarkingForge_Pack_Animation.json`	Keyframing: transform with the animation coordinate systems, every key command, playback and time, curves, tangents and layers - with Track View commands when the cursor is over Track View.	Animate transform (Ctrl+Alt+1, was: Transform), Keys (Ctrl+Alt+8, was: Viewports), Playback and time (Shift+Alt+4, was: Render), Curves and layers (Shift+Alt+5, was: Animation)
LookDev `MarkingForge_Pack_LookDev.json`	Look development: viewport shading and overrides, light display and shadows, camera controls.	Cameras (Ctrl+Alt+3, was: Lights and cameras), Shading (Shift+Alt+1, was: Viewport display), Lights (Shift+Alt+7, was: Tools and setup)
Archviz `MarkingForge_Pack_Archviz.json`	Architectural visualisation and layout: placing, arraying and aligning, snaps, layers and groups, references and files.	Place and array (Ctrl+Alt+1, was: Transform), Snaps (Ctrl+Alt+5, was: Snaps and grid), Layers and groups (Shift+Alt+6, was: Scene), References and files (Shift+Alt+8, was: File)

Modelling pack

Hard-surface and poly modelling: the poly tools on one key whatever the sub-object level, symmetry and mirror tools, combining and cutting, and a viewport check dial.

File: `Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_Modelling.json`

Ctrl+Alt+6 Poly tools

dial 14 - replaces Show and hide

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Poly tools* - file `Dials\Packs\Modelling – Poly tools.mfdial`

NW Target Weld	**N** Quickslice	**NE** Cut
W Inset	**Poly tools**	**E** Connect
SW Bevel	**S** Extrude	**SE** Chamfer

List under the dial: Swift Loop · Remove Loop · Flow Connect · Distance Connect · Make planar · Tessellate · Hinge · Outline

Ctrl+Alt+8 Symmetry and mirror

dial 16 - replaces Viewports

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Symmetry and mirror* - file `Dials\Packs\Modelling – Symmetry and mirror.mfdial`

NW + Mirror	**N** + Symmetry	**NE** Symmetry tools
W - to +	**Symmetry and mirror**	**E** + to -
SW Copy	**S** Flip	**SE** Paste

List under the dial: Mirror element X · Mirror element Y · Mirror element Z · Symmetry select X · Mirror (object)...

Shift+Alt+1 Combine and cut

dial 17 - replaces Viewport display

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Combine and cut* - file `Dials\Packs\Modelling – Combine and cut.mfdial`

NW + Cap Holes	**N** ProCutter	**NE** ShapeMerge
W + Welder	**Combine and cut**	**E** Connect
SW Snapshot...	**S** Collapse stack	**SE** Attach

List under the dial: Detach · + Vertex Weld · + Slice · + Chamfer

Shift+Alt+4 Viewport check

dial 20 - replaces Render

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Viewport check* - file `Dials\Packs\Modelling – Viewport check.mfdial`

NW Zoom selected	**N** Edged faces	**NE** See-through
W Wireframe / shaded	**Viewport check**	**E** Statistics
SW Backface cull	**S** Isolate	**SE** Facets

List under the dial: Clay · Realistic with maps · Default shading · Wireframe · Vertex ticks

Animation pack

Keyframing: transform with the animation coordinate systems, every key command, playback and time, curves, tangents and layers - with Track View commands when the cursor is over Track View.

File: `Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_Animation.json`

Ctrl+Alt+1 Animate transform

dial 9 - replaces Transform

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Animate transform* - file `Dials\Packs\Animation – Animate transform.mfdial`

NW Coords: world	**N** Move	**NE** Rotate
W Coords: local	**Animate transform**	**E** Scale
SW Coords: parent	**S** Freeze transform	**SE** Coords: gimbal

List under the dial: Freeze position · Freeze rotation · Link · Unlink · Select parent · Select child

Ctrl+Alt+8 Keys

dial 16 - replaces Viewports

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Keys* - file `Dials\Packs\Animation – Keys.mfdial`

NW Key mode	**N** Key all	**NE** Key position
W Auto Key	**Keys**	**E** Key rotation
SW Set Key mode	**S** Set keys	**SE** Key scale

List under the dial: Key pos, rot, scale · Set key selected · Clear Set Key buffer · Create key

Shift+Alt+4 Playback and time

dial 20 - replaces Render

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Playback and time* - file `Dials\Packs\Animation – Playback and time.mfdial`

NW Ghosting	**N** Play	**NE** Next frame
W Previous frame	**Playback and time**	**E** Go to end
SW Go to start	**S** Motion paths	**SE** Time configuration...

List under the dial: SMPTE / frames · Show key times

Shift+Alt+5 Curves and layers

dial 21 - replaces Animation

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Curves and layers* - file `Dials\Packs\Animation – Curves and layers.mfdial`

NW Merge animation...	**N** Track View	**NE** Animation layers...
W Default tangent: stepped	**Curves and layers**	**E** Default tangent: linear
SW Reaction manager...	**S** Default tangent: auto	**SE** Default tangent: smooth

List under the dial: Default tangent: spline · Default tangent: fast · Default tangent: slow · Save animation... · Load animation...

Changes to **Track View** when cursor over Track View.

LookDev pack

Look development: viewport shading and overrides, light display and shadows, camera controls.

File: `Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_LookDev.json`

Ctrl+Alt+3 Cameras

dial 11 - replaces Lights and cameras

Alone, from the dial library: *LookDev: Cameras* - file `Dials\Packs\LookDev - Cameras.mfdial`

NW Roll	**N** Camera view	**NE** Match camera to view
W Dolly	**Cameras**	**E** Safe frames
SW Field of view	**S** Hide cameras	**SE** Align camera

List under the dial: Truck · Pan camera · Select camera · Select target · Viewport camera 1 · More cameras...

Shift+Alt+1 Shading

dial 17 - replaces Viewport display

Alone, from the dial library: *LookDev: Shading* - file `Dials\Packs\LookDev - Shading.mfdial`

NW Fast shader	**N** Realistic with maps	**NE** Realistic, no maps
W Override off	**Shading**	**E** Shaded with maps
SW Clay	**S** Default shading	**SE** UV checker

List under the dial: Override: render setting · Hidden line · Default / scene lights

Shift+Alt+7 Lights

dial 23 - replaces Tools and setup

Alone, from the dial library: *LookDev: Lights* - file `Dials\Packs\LookDev - Lights.mfdial`

NW Lock lights	**N** Light Explorer	**NE** Shadows on
W Light view	**Lights**	**E** Default / scene lights
SW Only selected lights	**S** Hide lights	**SE** Shadows off

List under the dial: Unlock lights · Select lighting lights · Select shadow lights · Add default lights · Environment...

Archviz pack

Architectural visualisation and layout: placing, arraying and aligning, snaps, layers and groups, references and files.

File: `Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_Archviz.json`

Ctrl+Alt+1 Place and array

dial 9 - replaces Transform

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: Place and array* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz – Place and array.mfdial`

NW Align...	**N** Place	**NE** Array...
W Clone	**Place and array**	**E** Spacing tool...
SW Mirror...	**S** Snapshot...	**SE** Clone and align...

List under the dial: Quick align · Normal align... · Type-in... · + Array modifier

Ctrl+Alt+5 Snaps

dial 13 - replaces Snaps and grid

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: Snaps* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz – Snaps.mfdial`

NW AutoGrid	**N** Snaps	**NE** Angle snap
W Cycle snap type	**Snaps**	**E** Percent snap
SW Axis constraints	**S** Snap to frozen	**SE** Snap settings...

List under the dial: Spinner snap · Hide grids · Grid top · Grid front

Shift+Alt+6 Layers and groups

dial 22 - replaces Scene

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: Layers and groups* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz – Layers and groups.mfdial`

NW Scene Explorer	**N** New layer	**NE** Add to layer
W Layer Explorer	**Layers and groups**	**E** Select layer
SW Freeze layer	**S** Hide layer	**SE** Isolate layer

List under the dial: Group · Ungroup · Open group · Close group · Attach to group · Detach from group

Changes to **Scene Explorer** when cursor over the Scene Explorer.

Shift+Alt+8 References and files

dial 24 - replaces File

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: References and files* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz – References and files.mfdial`

NW Summary info...	**N** XRef scene...	**NE** XRef objects...
W Save incremental	References and files	**E** Merge...
SW Archive...	**S** Import...	**SE** Replace...

List under the dial: Save · Export... · Export selected... · Save selected... · Project paths...

Make your own pack

1. Arrange the dials you want to share in the editor.
2. **Save preset...** writes your layout to one file - the dials, their pages and the dial colours, without usage data or paths.
3. To share only some dials, remove the others from the file in a text editor: a preset replaces exactly the dials it holds (keys `"1"` to `"24"` under `"menus"`).
4. Scripts in a preset are removed when somebody else loads it, unless they choose **Load WITH the scripts** - wherever they sit: directions, list rows, the tap item, submenus and variants. Prefer 3ds Max commands for anything you share.

A preset holds what each dial shows, with that dial's own colours - not a dial's other sets (the pages under the mouse wheel) and not the colours set for every dial. Two other ways to share:

- **One dial: Save dial...**, or right-click the dial > **Save Menu N (...) to a file...** - a `.mfdial` file, loaded with **Load dial...** in place of a dial or as a new set of it.
- **Everything: Save every dial...** writes every dial and every set to a dated folder, with the colours of every dial; **Load every dial...** puts it all back. Scripts in these files are removed on loading too, unless the person loading them keeps them.
- **A colour look to go with it: Colours...** > **Presets** > **Export this preset to a file...** (a `.mfcolors` file; **Import a preset from a file...** on the other side).

Support, bug reports and feature requests

ISSUES	github.com/Forge-Plugins/MarkingForge/issues
ROADMAP	trello.com/b/7gJVqG8Y/markingforge-features-roadmap
E-MAIL	forgeplugins@gmail.com
WEB	https://forgeplugins.tech (forgeplugins.tech - more plugins by the author)

Bug reports and feature requests are best opened as issues on GitHub - the forms there ask for exactly what is needed, and you can follow the fix. Questions, and anything you would rather not post publicly (licence, purchase), go to the e-mail address. Every message is read.

Reporting a bug

1. In 3ds Max choose **MarkingForge > Report a bug...** - it copies your 3ds Max version, MarkingForge version, configuration summary and start-up log to the clipboard. It works even when the plugin did not load.
2. Open github.com/Forge-Plugins/MarkingForge/issues and pick **Bug report** - or write an e-mail to forgeplugins@gmail.com instead. Both are links in the window that opens (since 1.5.20), one click each.
3. Say what you did, what you expected and what happened instead, then paste the details with **Ctrl+V**.
4. Add a screenshot if you can. When the problem is in one dial, attach a preset of it (editor > **Save preset...**).

Suggesting a feature

Open an issue with the **Feature request** form, choose **MarkingForge > Suggest a feature...**, or simply write. Describe what you would like to do and how you do it today - a concrete example from your work says more than a list of wishes. Ideas for new built-in dials, commands and options are all welcome. What is already planned and in progress is on the **Roadmap** above - **MarkingForge > Roadmap (Trello)** opens it too.

Nothing is sent by the plugin itself: the details go to the clipboard and your own e-mail program, so you see everything that leaves your computer. MarkingForge has no network access.